



Quillmark

FOUNDER BRIEF · AGENT PIPELINE · 5-YEAR BOARD PLAN

The Model, The Mentor, The Map

Why print-on-demand should fire you up the way NicheQuill did — the proven operator to learn it from, the agent pipeline that makes it rinse-and-repeat, and the five-year plan to run Quillmark side-by-side with your other engines.

Companion to **The Built-In Package** · A **BNBHubs** venture · v1.0

Confidential. Projections are planning assumptions, not guarantees. First-pass research, not legal advice.

1 · The Mentor — Ryan Hogue, the “Leon of POD”

You asked for the person who proves this works — the POD equivalent of Leon. That person is **Ryan Hogue** (channel: *Ryan Hogue Passive Income*, @RyanHoguePassiveIncome). Here is why he should light the same fire.

The part that matters most

He got rich **running** the business, then taught it — not the other way around. A former senior web developer and adjunct professor (~\$117k/yr salary) who started a \$0 print-on-demand side hustle on Amazon in 2017, expanded it across Etsy, Walmart, eBay and Redbubble, and grew it into **~\$49k/month** across ~10 passive-income streams (~\$500k+/yr). CNBC profiled him in 2024 and made him an instructor in their passive-income course. His entire brand is one word: **automation**.

Why it should hit you the way NicheQuill did

Ryan built his automation **by hand, alone, over years** — scraping niches, uploading designs across marketplaces, wiring up tools like his own *PODTurbo* uploader. **You already have the agent stack he wished he had.** Same method, you skip the grind. His one-line method is almost exactly the NicheQuill move applied to merch:

Ryan’s method in one line

Find a proven niche/phrase → generate the design → list it across multiple POD marketplaces → let winners compound, kill the losers.

Watch in this order (the belief-builder)

#	Video	Why watch it
1	Print-on-Demand Starter Guide (w/ Ryan Hogue)	The whole model in one beginner video
2	Ryan Hogue’s Print On Demand Tips For Success	How he actually picks winners & scales
3	Making Print On Demand Money Online with Ryan Hogue	Real numbers & mindset — the fire-starter
4	How to Automate 100% of Your Amazon POD Business (short)	This is literally your agent model
5	Printful POD Review / Tutorial for Beginners	The fulfilment side, start to finish

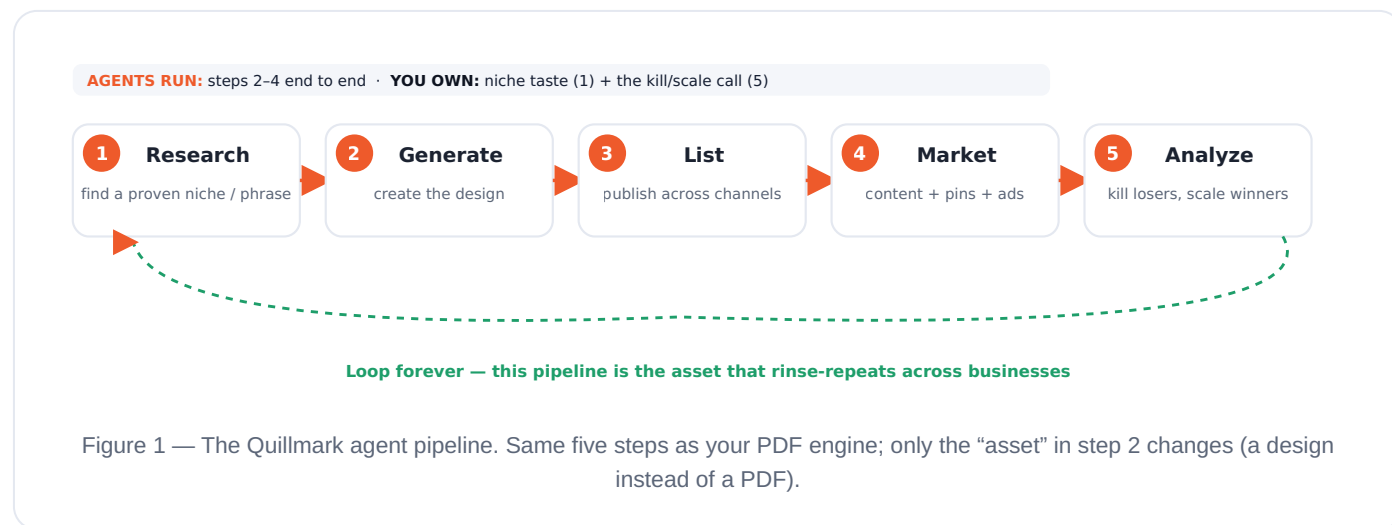
Links are in the Sources page at the back. On his channel, also search his niche-research and Redbubble-automation uploads — those are the exact “find a 5,000-sales/month niche” move, applied to merch.

Stay sharp: the vet-before-you-buy filter

“100% automated, undeniable proof, fully scalable” is exactly what low-quality gurus sell. Ryan is legit, but apply your own discipline before paying for any course: **(1)** Do they earn from the method or from teaching it? **(2)** Independent proof, not just testimonials on their own funnel. **(3)** Who owns the customer (Etsy/Amazon can switch you off)? **(4)** Is the automation real, or hidden daily hustle? The honest truth everywhere is **80–95% automated after setup**, not 100%.

2 · The Agent Pipeline — what actually rinse-repeats

You said you love the agent pipeline — here it is, formalized. The thing that clones across businesses is **not the concept, it's this pipeline**. Research a niche, generate the asset, list it, market it, iterate. Models where this transfers with almost no change are the true clones of your PDF engine.



Where each business reuses this pipeline (the rinse-repeat map)

Business	Asset in step 2	Pipeline reuse	Verdict
NicheQuill / PDFtrender	Digital PDF guide	— (the original)	Proven model, validate revenue first
Quillmark POD	A design on products	Step 2 swaps; 3–4 add channels	Closest physical cousin
Kindle KDP / low-content books	Book interior + cover	Near-identical pipeline	True clone — build next
Digital templates (Notion/Canva)	A template file	Near-identical pipeline	True clone — build next
Stock asset packs	Presets/fonts/prompts	Near-identical pipeline	True clone
	TTS of existing PDFs	Pure margin add-on	Free upside later

Business	Asset in step 2	Pipeline reuse	Verdict
Audiobooks of your guides			
Faceless YouTube / SEO sites	Video / article	New pipeline from scratch	Not a quick clone

The discipline that protects the whole portfolio

Rinse-and-repeat is the right instinct — but **repeat a model after one instance has pulled real money, not before**. PDFTrender is built but not yet revenue-validated. “Undeniable proof” describes Leon’s / Ryan’s numbers, not yet yours. Cloning an unproven bet 5× is 5× the risk, not 5× the income. Smart order: prove one, then clone the **pipeline** (KDP and templates first, because your agents barely change).

3 · Running Quillmark side-by-side (the “two engines by Friday” play)

Your plan is sound: stage Quillmark now while the Shopify/PDFTrender store finishes baking, so by week’s end you have two engines live and can watch which one pulls. This is the right use of the wait — with one rule to keep it from becoming chaos.

	NicheQuill / PDFTrender	Quillmark POD
Sells	Digital PDF guides	Original designs on physical products
Delivery	Instant download (zero cost/order)	Printed & shipped on demand (cost/order)
Margin	Very high (~95%+)	Healthy (~30–45%)
Channel	Shopify store	Etsy first, then Shopify + Amazon Merch
Status	Built, awaiting launch (Fri)	Stage now, launch alongside
Shared engine	The 5-step agent pipeline	The same 5-step pipeline

The one rule for two engines

Each engine gets its **own dashboard and its own weekly review**, but they share the same batch block and the same pipeline. Watch leading indicators side-by-side (reach → visits → sales). Pour more time into whichever engine shows the earlier, cheaper sales — let the data, not the excitement, allocate your hours.

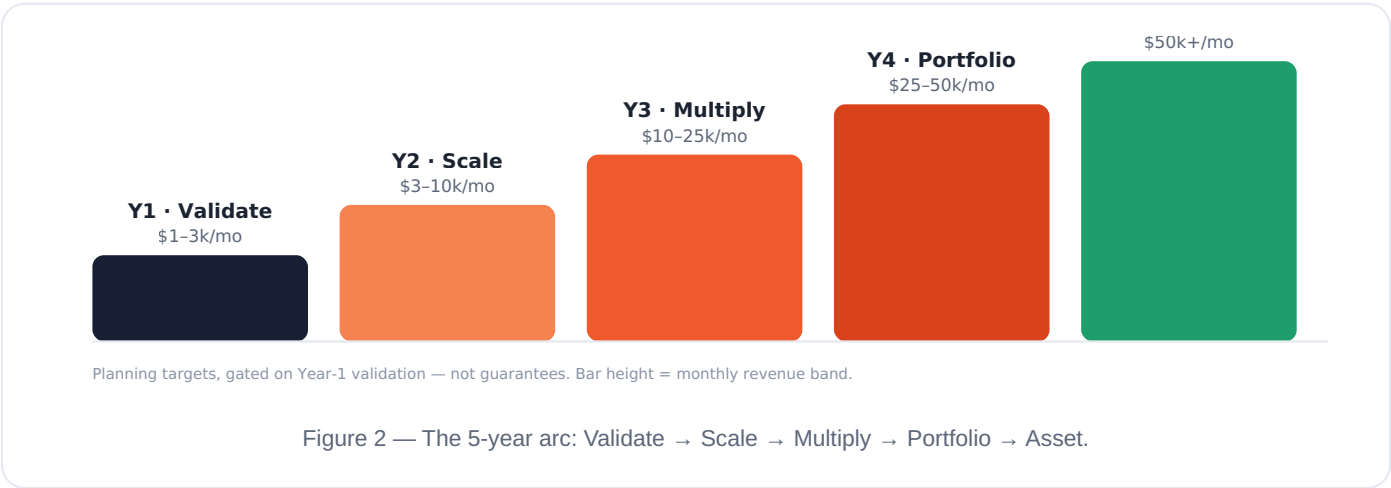
Capital plan for the side-by-side test

Quillmark start \$15-\$150 Etsy lean → Shopify standard	NicheQuill \$0 Already built; launching Fri	optional ad test \$150-\$450 only on a proven design	total at risk <\$600 to run both engines for a month
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You said you have funds to test something side-by-side — this is a low-cap test, not a big bet. The real investment is the content sprint, not cash.

4 · The 5-Year Board Plan

Same long-horizon format as the PDFTrender board plan: where Quillmark goes each year, what unlocks the next rung, and how it fits the BNBHubs portfolio. Every figure is a planning target gated on the prior year's validation.



Year	Theme	Revenue target*	What you do	What unlocks the next year
1	Validate & systemize	\$1–3k/mo by month 12	Launch Quillmark on Etsy; ship 150–400 listings; run the agent pipeline + 30-day content engine; find 3–5 winning designs/niches	Proof: a repeatable content → traffic → sale loop and real reviews
2	Scale the winners	\$3–10k/mo	Add Shopify + Amazon Merch + Redbubble; email list; light paid ads on proven designs only; hire first VA for listings/CS	ROAS ≥ 2 on ads; an audience you own
3	Multiply	\$10–25k/mo	Clone the pipeline into 2–3 adjacent niches/sub-brands; bring on a designer; ads manager; document every SOP	A team + SOPs running the pipeline without you in every step
4	Portfolio	\$25–50k/mo	Run Quillmark as one node of a multi-brand POD portfolio; reinvest into the other true-clone engines (KDP, templates)	Diversified, semi-autonomous brands; strong cash position
5	Asset & optionality	\$50k+/mo	Mature brand(s) with their own equity: license designs, or operate for cash, or sell a brand (POD/ecom brands sell at multiples of profit)	A sellable asset — or a cash machine you choose to keep

*Targets assume consistent execution and that Year-1 validation succeeds. POD is competitive; treat these as direction, not promises.

Portfolio fit (BNBHubs)

Quillmark is the **physical-product arm** of the BNBHubs “Quill” house (alongside NicheQuill’s digital guides). It diversifies revenue across *digital* and *physical*, shares the same agent pipeline, and does not compete for the same hours as the core businesses — the definition of a good portfolio addition.

Compliance & values alignment

The model is asset-based and requires no interest-based financing to start (halal-friendly): you sell things you make. Keep it clean — **original or licensed art only** (never brands, logos, characters, lyrics, names), honest marketing (no fake scarcity or false claims), and clear shipping/returns. This single discipline protects Quillmark and the BNBHubs umbrella.

5 · Founder & Operator Manual (quick reference)

The operating detail lives in *The Built-In Package* (§8). This is the one-page command card: who decides what, the cadence, and the numbers that matter.

Roles & decision rights

Role	Who	Owns
CEO / Board	You	Niche bets, brand, budget, the kill/scale calls
Operator (pipeline)	Agents + you	Research, design, listing, content, fulfilment routing
Support (later)	VA	Listings at volume, customer service, scheduling
Creative (later)	Freelance designer	Design volume in proven niches

The cadence

Daily (30–45 min)

- Orders & messages (templates)
- Post today’s pre-made content
- 5 outreach DMs · reply/engage
- Glance at the dashboard

Weekly / Monthly

- Weekly: batch 3–5 designs + 7 videos; 2–4 listings; 1 email; review numbers
- Monthly: cut losers, scale winners, set ad budget, plan next niches

The numbers that matter

Metric	Healthy target	Why
Gross margin / order	30–45%	Keeps the model worth running
Conversion rate	1.5–3%	Listing/proof quality signal

Metric	Healthy target	Why
ROAS (if ads on)	$\geq 2.0x$	Green light to scale spend
Repeat rate	15%+ (with email)	Cheapest revenue you'll get
Winners found	3–5 in Y1	The real Year-1 deliverable

The first move (Monday)

Stage Quillmark now: lock the name, open the Etsy store, publish ONE design, and start the content calendar — so by Friday both engines are live and you're comparing real data, not guessing.

Sources & links

Grounded in current web research (May 2026), not memory. Ryan Hogue's figures are self-reported / press-reported; verify before paying for any course.

Ryan Hogue — profile & press

- CNBC: How I build lucrative side hustles (\$11,400/wk) — cnbc.com/2024/05/02/passive-income-expert-ryan-hogue-how-i-build-lucrative-side-hustles.html
- CNBC: Top passive-income side-hustle myths — cnbc.com/2024/03/25/ryan-hogue-top-passive-income-side-hustle-myths.html
- CNBC: Favorite \$0 side hustles — cnbc.com/2024/04/24/ryan-hogue-on-his-favorite-zero-dollar-side-hustles.html
- CNBC author hub — cnbc.com/ryan-hogue/
- Channel: YouTube “Ryan Hogue Passive Income” (@RyanHoguePassiveIncome) · site: ryanhogue.com

Videos (verified URLs)

- Print-on-Demand Starter Guide — youtube.com/watch?v=b_Sx8wz5BWY
- Print On Demand Tips For Success — youtube.com/watch?v=gmb6Xq_H8XA
- Making Print On Demand Money Online — youtube.com/watch?v=uGZjMs01ja0
- Automate 100% of Your Amazon POD (short) — youtube.com/watch?v=qMyI_zmL4rs
- Printful Review / Beginner Tutorial — youtube.com/watch?v=ONAvPYV0GZk

Balance / skeptic read (do your own diligence)

- Medium: “Ryan Hogue: CNBC’s Passive Income Prophet ... or Poser?” (a critical view — read it before buying a course)

Companion to **Quillmark POD — The Built-In Package**. Consolidates the Ryan Hogue founder brief, the agent pipeline, the side-by-side launch plan, the 5-year board plan, and the founder/operator quick reference. Planning assumptions for decision-making, not financial or legal guarantees; run a formal USPTO (class 25 apparel + 35 retail) and domain check before committing ad spend.